

Saath Charitable Trust



Founded

1989, Ahmedabad

Founders

Rajendra Joshi, Pradeep Seth and Robert David

Sector

Community Development

"Inclusive and empowered communities and individuals"

Recognition

- India NGO Award
- GuideStar Platinum Award
- HUDCO Award
- Gujarat CSR Leadership and Inspire Awards (2018–19)

About Saath

Saath, meaning "together," was registered as a public charitable trust in Ahmedabad on 28 February 1989 by three friends. With no office and no formal funding, they set out to transform low-income settlements through integrated slum development and bring them into the mainstream of the city.

Its mission is to make human settlements equitable living environments where all residents have access to health, education, essential infrastructure and livelihoods,

irrespective of economic and social status. From the late 1990s it developed a market-based approach, treating communities as participants and market actors rather than beneficiaries.

From a single settlement in Behrampura, Saath has grown to work across Gujarat, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, impacting over 10 lakh people in city slums and villages alike.



Core Programmes

Livable Spaces and Neighbourhoods

Slum Networking, slum electrification, Griha Pravesh affordable housing and Urban Resource Centres. Integrated Area Development now spans six wards of East Ahmedabad.

Livelihood and Circular Economy

Umeed youth skilling, Nirman for construction workers, Business Gym for nano-entrepreneurs, Women@Work, and RWeaves for Patola and Tangaliya weavers.

Healthcare

From early TB and mother-and-child care to an urban health partnership with IIM Ahmedabad and the AMC, a COVID-19 community response with UNICEF, and lead-toxicity camps recognised by ICMR.

Education

Pre-schools since the early 1990s, 191 anganwadis run with the AMC across 25 wards, and child rights work in 120 villages.

Financial and Digital Literacy

Savings groups since 1990, the Sakhi Mahila Mandal for women across castes and religions, and the Saath Savings and Credit Cooperative.

Climate Resilience and Rural Work

Earthquake relief in 2001, support to fishermen after Cyclone Biparjoy, and a Model Village Mission in Sanand and Vaghra.

Impact

10 lakh+

People impacted across urban and rural India

27,000

Households under Integrated Area Development (2021–25)

5,000

Households electrified in Juhapura (2003)

2,000+

Weavers federated in SUVAS (2008)

55

Umeed skilling centres in 8 districts (2007)

8,000+

Ration kits during COVID-19 (2020–21)